

Tuesday, 25 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

23° 14°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

20° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **The Prime Minister has condemned the sharing of dangerous driving videos online, calling the practice 'truly reprehensible'.**

His comments come as the government has urged social media platforms, including TikTok, to remove videos depicting dangerous driving, such as wrong-way driving incidents. Authorities are concerned about the potential for these videos to encourage reckless behaviour.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **Former world snooker champion Graeme Dott has been found guilty of child sex abuse.**

The Scottish snooker player was convicted of lewd and libidinous behaviour towards both a young girl and a boy. The details of the case have sent shockwaves through the sporting world.

CRIME · UK

- 3 **Victims have described a 'house of terror' where they suffered horrific abuse at the hands of their mother, grandmother, and stepfather.**

Shirley Freeman, Julia Stephen, and David McColl subjected their victims to beatings, starvation, and severe psychological torment. The harrowing details emerged during the court proceedings.

CRIME · UK

- 4 **Graduate job vacancies across the UK have reportedly plummeted by almost 50% in the past year.**

According to job site Adzuna, the number of available graduate positions is now at its lowest point since 2016. This significant drop raises concerns for those entering the job market.

ECONOMY · UK

- 5 **The Reform party has announced plans to prioritise British-born workers for social housing, if they were to come to power.**

Labour has swiftly criticised the proposal, labelling it 'unserious and unworkable' and accusing Reform of pushing 'gimmicks and division'. The policy is set to spark further political debate.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- The sons of 'The Wicker Man' director have finally completed their late father's folk horror film trilogy.**
More than 50 years after the original, the final film brings a sense of closure to the saga and to the family of its creator. Fans of the cult classic will be keen to see the conclusion.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of 'The Wicker Man'? What are your hopes for the final film in the trilogy?
FILM · COMING SOON

- A hidden museum gallery is set to reopen its doors to the public after being closed for an incredible 83 years.**
The gallery, which has been inaccessible since 1943, will welcome visitors again from September 16th. It promises a rare glimpse into a long-unseen collection.

ON AIR – What kind of forgotten treasures do you think might be unveiled in a gallery that's been closed for over eight decades?
CULTURE · SEPTEMBER

- A blue plaque has been proudly unveiled at the former home of the beloved Paddington Bear creator.**
The chairman of the local society described it as a day where 'friends were reunited', celebrating the legacy of the much-loved author. It's a lovely tribute to a literary icon.

ON AIR – Paddington Bear has brought joy to so many. What's your favourite Paddington moment or memory?
LITERATURE · NOW

- The Killers frontman Brandon Flowers is asking big questions about fame on his upcoming third solo album.**
He's taken a detour into country music for this new release, exploring whether fame is truly worth it. It's a reflective new sound for the rock star.

ON AIR – Brandon Flowers is questioning if fame is worth it. What do you think are the biggest downsides to being globally famous?
MUSIC · COMING SOON

- Leaked clips appearing to show the highly anticipated Grand Theft Auto 6 have surfaced online.**
While some might see it as a nightmare, others are wondering if these leaks will actually hurt the biggest video game of the year. The gaming world is buzzing with speculation.

ON AIR – If you're a gamer, do you think these leaks will spoil the experience of GTA 6, or just build up more excitement?
GAMING · COMING SOON

On the schedule

1 **England pace bowler Brydon Carse has been dropped from the squad for the second Test against Pakistan following a nightclub incident.**

Carse was removed after an incident that led to him being handcuffed by police. This is another blow for England cricket, dealing with off-field issues.

ON AIR – It seems England cricket is having a tough time with player discipline. What do you think needs to happen to get things back on track?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Coco Gauff has powered past Jessica Pegula to win the Cincinnati Open, just before the US Open begins.**

This marks Gauff's first title of 2026, building significant momentum heading into the final Grand Slam of the year. Arthur Fils took home the men's title.

ON AIR – With the US Open just around the corner, do you think Coco Gauff's Cincinnati win makes her a favourite for the title?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

3 **Lando Norris and McLaren secured a second consecutive win at the Dutch Grand Prix, but Norris remains cautious.**

Despite the victory, Norris says he and McLaren 'don't have the car' to fight for a championship this season. It's a realistic assessment from the British driver.

ON AIR – Lando Norris is winning races but says McLaren isn't championship-ready. What more do you think they need to challenge for the title?

F1 · THIS WEEK

4 **Former Liverpool manager Rafa Benitez has shared his thoughts on his former players, Xabi Alonso and Alvaro Arbeloa, who now face each other as managers.**

The two ex-teammates will go head-to-head on Monday as Fulham host Chelsea. Benitez commented on Alonso's strategic mind and Arbeloa's surprising rise to management.

ON AIR – It's always interesting when former teammates become rival managers. Which former players do you think would make the best football managers?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Newcastle and Liverpool united in a heartfelt tribute to the legendary Kevin Keegan on the opening weekend of the Premier League season.**

Both clubs, where Keegan left an indelible mark, honoured the football icon. It was a fitting moment to remember one of the game's greats.

ON AIR – Kevin Keegan is a true legend for both Newcastle and Liverpool. Who do you think is the greatest player to have played for two rival clubs?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that listening to the sound of rainfall can significantly improve concentration and reduce stress.**

Researchers suggest the consistent, non-intrusive sound acts as a natural white noise, helping to block out distractions and promote a sense of calm. So, next time it rains, perhaps open a window and embrace the tranquility.

- 2 The trend for 'micro-adventures' is soaring, with more Brits choosing short, local escapades to boost their wellbeing.**

Think a sunrise walk up a nearby hill, wild swimming in a local lake, or an overnight camp in a garden. It's all about finding adventure close to home, proving you don't need to travel far to feel refreshed.

- 3 Scientists have found that looking at photos of cute baby animals can make people more productive.**

Apparently, the dose of cuteness triggers a positive emotional response, which in turn enhances focus and attention to detail. Perhaps a few puppy pictures on your desktop might not be such a distraction after all!

- 4 A delightful surge in 'community seed swaps' is helping gardeners share unusual plants and promote biodiversity.**

From heirloom tomatoes to exotic herbs, these local events are bringing green-fingered enthusiasts together to exchange seeds, tips, and cultivate new friendships along the way.

- 5 Research suggests that wearing colourful clothes can genuinely lift your mood and even positively influence those around you.**

It seems a splash of bright yellow or a vibrant blue isn't just a fashion statement; it can act as a natural mood enhancer. Time to ditch the drab and embrace the rainbow!

- 6 The simple joy of 'writing a letter' is experiencing a charming revival amongst all age groups.**

From pen pals connecting across continents to heartfelt notes for loved ones, the act of putting pen to paper is being rediscovered as a meaningful way to communicate and slow down in our digital world.

- 7 Apparently, doing a quick 'five-minute tidy-up' before leaving the house can significantly reduce stress levels later in the day.**

Psychologists suggest that returning to a slightly tidier space creates a sense of calm and order, making evenings feel more relaxing. Just a little habit that makes a big difference!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new book will be interesting, without reading the blurb properly?

ANSWER: THEY SMELL THE PAGES, HOPING FOR THAT LOVELY 'NEW BOOK' SCENT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot bubble bath. What is it?

ANSWER: THEY CAREFULLY ARRANGE ALL THEIR BATH-SIDE PRODUCTS IN A NEAT LINE, EVEN IF THEY WON'T USE THEM ALL.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a certain 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment from your past?**

What's that one smell for you – maybe freshly cut grass, a particular perfume, or even the scent of an old book – that just instantly takes you on a trip down memory lane? And what memory does it bring back?

- **We all have those 'little everyday moments of satisfaction' that just make us feel quietly pleased, don't we?**

What's your small, everyday achievement that just hits the spot? Is it perfectly parallel parking, getting all the laundry folded in one go, or perhaps just finding that elusive matching sock?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can sometimes be heard as a soft crackling sound due to electromagnetic interference.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually started in a bakery on Pudding Lane.
- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a group of berries that have fused together.
- The world's oldest known living tree is Methuselah, a Bristlecone Pine in California, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The sound of a human sneeze can travel at speeds of up to 100 miles per hour.
- The total weight of all the ants on Earth is thought to be greater than the total weight of all the humans.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if they wanted to!
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlilllantysiliogogogoch, a village in Wales.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.

On this day

Day 237 of the year, 128 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Æbbe of Coldingham; Christian feast day: Aredius; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Arles; Christian feast day: Genesisius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Anthony Heald, American actor
- 1969 — Cameron Mathison, Canadian actor and television personality
- 1987 — Blake Lively, American model and actress
- 1938 — Frederick Forsyth, English journalist and author (died 2025)
- 1968 — Stuart Murdoch, Scottish singer-songwriter
- 1939 — Marshall Brickman, Brazilian-American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2024)
- 1974 — Eric Millegan, American actor
- 1960 — Ashley Crow, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1980 — The last performance of the Jahrhundertring at the Bayreuth Festival receives ovations of 45 minutes.
- 2003 — NASA successfully launches the Spitzer Space Telescope into space.
- 1989 — Voyager 2 spacecraft makes its closest approach to Neptune, the last planet in the Solar System at the time, due to Pluto being within Neptune's orbit from 1979 to 1999.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2010 — A Filair Let L-410 Turbolet crashes on approach to Bandundu Airport, killing 20.
- 1958 — The world's first publicly marketed instant noodles, Chikin Ramen, are introduced by Taiwanese-Japanese businessman Momofuku Ando.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — Bar Harbor Airlines Flight 1808 crashes near Auburn/Lewiston Municipal Airport in Auburn, Maine, killing all eight people on board including peace activist and child actress Samantha Smith.
- 1945 — The August Revolution ends as Emperor Bảo Đại abdicates, ending the Nguyễn dynasty.

- 1948 — The House Un-American Activities Committee holds first-ever televised congressional hearing: "Confrontation Day" between Whittaker Chambers and Alger Hiss.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 238 of the year, 127 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Bergamo (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Ceferino Namuncurá; Christian feast day: Jeanne-Elisabeth Bichier des Ages; Christian feast day: Blessed John Paul I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Nik Turner, English musician and songwriter (died 2022)
- 2002 — Lil Tecca, American rapper
- 1941 — Jane Marrow, English actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1970 — Melissa McCarthy, American actress, comedian, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Alison Steadman, English actress
- 1941 — Chris Curtis, English drummer and singer (died 2005)
- 1940 — Michael Cockerell, English journalist
- 1980 — Macaulay Culkin, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2014 — The Jay Report into the Rotherham child sexual exploitation scandal is published.
- 1980 — After John Birges plants a bomb at Harvey's Resort Hotel in Stateline, Nevada, in the United States, the FBI inadvertently detonates the bomb during its disarming.
- 2021 — During the 2021 Kabul airlift, a suicide bombing at Hamid Karzai International Airport kills 13 US military personnel and at least 169 Afghan civilians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1966 — The South African Border War starts with the battle at Omugulugwombashe.
- 2018 — Three people are killed and eleven wounded during a mass shooting at a Madden NFL '19 video game tournament in Jacksonville, Florida.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar